

CHAPTER 1

# The Rise of Nationalism in Europe

NCERT Exercise Solutions


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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples- write your own.

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## Activity · Introduction (Fig. 1)

**? In what way do you think this print (Fig. 1) depicts a utopian vision?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sorrieu's print shows an **ideal world** that did not exist in 1848:

- Peoples of Europe and America, men and women of all ages and classes, march together and pay homage to the statue of **Liberty**.
- The symbols of **absolutist institutions** lie shattered on the ground.
- All peoples are grouped as **distinct nations** with their own flags and costumes, living in peace.
- Christ, saints and angels gaze from heaven, showing **fraternity among nations**.
- Germany carries a flag although it was **not yet a united nation**.

So it is utopian: a world of free, democratic nation-states living in brotherhood was a dream, unlikely to exist at that time.

## Discuss · Source A – Ernst Renan, 'What is a Nation?'

**Summarise the attributes of a nation, as Renan understands them. Why, in his view, are nations important?**

✔ ANSWER

**Attributes of a nation (Renan):**

- A nation is **not** formed by a common language, race, religion or territory.
- It is the result of a **long past** of endeavours, sacrifice and devotion – a heroic past, great men and glory.
- People share **common glories** in the past and a **common will** in the present; they have done great deeds together and wish to do more.
- A nation is a **large-scale solidarity**; its existence is a **daily plebiscite** (people's continued consent).
- A nation has no real interest in annexing or holding a country against its will.

**Why nations are important:** their existence is a **guarantee of liberty**. Liberty would be lost if the world had only one law and only one master.

## 💬 Discuss · Source B – Friedrich List on the Zollverein

**? Describe the political ends that List hopes to achieve through economic measures.**

✔ ANSWER

- List wants the **zollverein** (customs union) to **bind the Germans economically into a nation**.
- By protecting German interests externally and raising internal productivity, it would **strengthen the nation materially**.
- A fusion of individual and provincial interests would **awaken national sentiment**.
- He believes a **free economic system** is the only means to create **national feeling**.

So his political goal is the **unification of the German states into one nation-state**, using economic unity as the base.

## 🧪 Activity · A New Conservatism after 1815

**? Plot on a map of Europe the changes drawn up by the Vienna Congress.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

On an outline map of Europe, mark these changes made by the Treaty of Vienna (1815):

- **France**: Bourbon dynasty restored; France loses the territories annexed under Napoleon.

- **Kingdom of the Netherlands** (including **Belgium**) set up in the north of France.
- **Genoa** added to **Piedmont** in the south.
- **Prussia**: new territories on its western frontiers, and a portion of **Saxony**.
- **Austria**: control of **northern Italy**.
- **Russia**: part of **Poland**.
- **German Confederation of 39 states** left untouched.

Use different colours for each power (Fig. 3 of the book shows Europe after 1815).

## 🤔 Discuss · Fig. 6 – The Club of Thinkers

**? What is the caricaturist trying to depict? (Fig. 6, The Club of Thinkers, c. 1820)**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- The caricature mocks the **censorship and repression** of the conservative regimes after 1815.
- The thinkers wear **muzzles**; the rules say 'Silence is the first commandment'.
- The meeting's question, 'How long will thinking be allowed to us?', shows that **freedom of speech and thought** was being taken away.
- It shows how autocratic governments did not tolerate criticism or dissent, and why liberals demanded **freedom of the press**.

## Discuss · The Romantic Imagination and National Feeling

**?** **Discuss the importance of language and popular traditions in the creation of national identity.**

✔ ANSWER

- **Romantics** believed a nation's true spirit lay in its common culture – language, folk songs, poetry, dances.
- **Herder** said true German culture was found among the common people (**das volk**); folk culture spread the spirit of the nation (**volksgeist**).
- Vernacular language and folklore carried the nationalist message to **large, mostly illiterate audiences**.
- **Grimm Brothers** collected German folktales and wrote a 33-volume German dictionary to oppose French domination and build a German identity.
- **Poland**: Karol Kurpinski turned folk dances (polonaise, mazurka) into national symbols; the clergy used the **Polish language** in church as a weapon against Russian rule.

Thus language and popular traditions gave people a **shared heritage**, which became the basis of national identity.

## Discuss and Activity · Hunger, Hardship and Popular Revolt

**Discuss** **Describe the cause of the Silesian weavers' uprising. Comment on the viewpoint of the journalist.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**Cause:**

- In 1845 the weavers of Silesia were extremely poor and desperate for work.
- **Contractors** supplied raw material and gave orders for finished cloth, but **drastically reduced their payments**, taking advantage of the weavers' need for jobs.
- When the weavers marched to the contractor's mansion demanding **higher wages**, they were treated with scorn and threats; this led to the revolt.

**Journalist's viewpoint (Wilhelm Wolff):**

- He is **sympathetic to the weavers**: he stresses their 'extreme misery' and the contractors' exploitation.
- He reports the violence of the weavers but also shows the contractor's selfishness – even the neighbouring village refused to shelter him – and that the army shot **eleven weavers**.

Activity **Imagine you are a weaver who saw the events as they unfolded. Write a report on what you saw.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**Report: Weavers' protest in our village, 4 June 1845**

We weavers have been starving for months because the contractors keep cutting the price they pay for our cloth. On 4 June at 2 p.m. a large crowd of us came out of our homes and marched in pairs to the contractor's mansion to ask for higher wages.

Instead of listening, he treated us with scorn and threats. Angry, some of our people forced their way into the house and smashed window-panes, furniture and porcelain. Others broke into the storehouse and tore the cloth to shreds.

The contractor fled with his family; the next village refused to shelter him. He came back 24 hours later with the army. In the clash that followed, eleven of our fellow weavers were shot dead.

We only wanted fair wages to feed our families. Today we mourn our brothers, but our demand for justice remains.

## Discuss · Source C – Liberty and equality for women

**?** **Compare the positions on the question of women's rights voiced by the three writers cited above. What do they reveal about liberal ideology?**

✔ ANSWER

| Writer | Position on women's rights |
|---|---|
| Carl Welcker (liberal, Frankfurt Parliament) | Against equality: men and women have different functions; woman is weaker and her sphere is the home; equality would destroy family harmony |
| Louise Otto-Peters (feminist) | For equality: 'Liberty is indivisible'; men who fight for liberty only for men are fighting for half of humanity |
| Anonymous reader (1850) | For voting rights: women own property and serve the state, yet even the 'stupidest cattle-herder' can vote while talented women cannot – an injustice |

**What it reveals about liberal ideology:**

- Liberals spoke of **liberty and equality before the law**, but many of them did **not extend political rights to women** (or to men without property).
- Liberalism was thus **limited and contradictory**; women were admitted to the Frankfurt parliament only as observers in the gallery.

- Women and their supporters had to fight within the liberal movement for **equal political rights**.

### 🧪 Activity · Fig. 13 – Caricature of Bismarck

**? Describe the caricature. How does it represent the relationship between Bismarck and the elected deputies of Parliament? What interpretation of democratic processes is the artist trying to convey?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Description:** Bismarck stands in the German Reichstag holding a **whip** in the air, while the elected deputies **hide/cower under their desks** in fear.
- **Relationship:** Bismarck acts like a **master**; the deputies are frightened and powerless, obeying him.
- **Message:** democracy in Germany was **only for show**. Real power lay with Bismarck and the Prussian state (army and bureaucracy), not with the elected Parliament. Germany was unified by force, not by democratic processes.

## Activity · Fig. 14 – Italy before and after unification

**1** **Look at Fig. 14(a). Do you think that the people living in any of these regions thought of themselves as Italians?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**No, most of them did not.**

- Italy was divided into **seven states**; only Sardinia-Piedmont was ruled by an Italian princely house. The north was under the Austrian Habsburgs, the centre under the Pope, the south under the Bourbon kings of Spain.
- Even the Italian language had **no common form** and had many regional variations.
- People's loyalty was to their own region or ruler. Even after unification, peasants in the south had never heard of *Italia* and thought 'La Talia' was Victor Emmanuel's wife.

**2** **Examine Fig. 14(b). Which was the first region to become a part of unified Italy? Which was the last region to join? In which year did the largest number of states join?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **First: Sardinia-Piedmont** (marked 1858 on the map), the kingdom that led the unification.
- **Last:** the **Papal States (Rome)**, in **1870**.

- **Largest number:** in **1858–60** (in 1860), when Parma, Modena, Tuscany and the Kingdom of the Two Sicilies joined. (Venetia joined in 1866.)

(check the picture in your book)

### 🧪 Activity · Fig. 15 – Garibaldi and the boot 'Italy'

? **The artist has portrayed Garibaldi as holding on to the base of the boot, so that the King of Sardinia-Piedmont can enter it from the top. Look at the map of Italy once more. What statement is this caricature making?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Italy is shaped like a **boot**. Garibaldi holds its **base – South Italy** – which he won with his Red Shirts (Expedition of the Thousand, 1860, Kingdom of the Two Sicilies).
- King Victor Emmanuel II enters from the **top – the north**, which Sardinia-Piedmont gained through war and diplomacy.
- The statement: **Garibaldi handed over the south he conquered to the king**, helping him become ruler of a united Italy. The unification was completed by the king, with Garibaldi's help, from both ends.

## 🧪 Activity · Box 3 – Veit's Germania

**1** **With the help of the chart in Box 3, identify the attributes of Veit's Germania and interpret the symbolic meaning of the painting.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

| Attribute | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Broken chains | Being freed |
| Breastplate with eagle | Strength of the German empire |
| Crown of oak leaves | Heroism |
| Sword | Readiness to fight |
| Olive branch around the sword | Willingness to make peace |
| Black, red and gold tricolour | Flag of the liberal-nationalists of 1848 |
| Rays of the rising sun | Beginning of a new era |

**Meaning:** Germania stands for the German nation – freed, strong and heroic, ready to fight but willing to make peace. Painted for the Frankfurt parliament (1848), it shows the hope of a **new era of a free, united, liberal Germany**.

**2** **In an earlier allegorical rendering of 1836, Veit had portrayed the Kaiser's crown at the place where he has now located the broken chain. Explain the significance of this change.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- The **crown** stood for monarchy and autocratic rule; the **broken chain** stands for **freedom**.
- The change shows the shift of 1848: the German people were now seen as freeing themselves from autocracy.
- It reflects the liberal hope that the nation would be built by the **people and their elected parliament**, not by kings.

## 🧪 Activity · Fig. 18 – The fallen Germania

**?** **Describe what you see in Fig. 17 [Fig. 18, The fallen Germania, Julius Hübner, 1850]. What historical events could Hübner be referring to in this allegorical vision of the nation?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Description:** Germania lies **fallen on the ground**, face down, as if dead or defeated. Her crown and sceptre lie on the ground and there is a skull nearby; the scene looks dark and hopeless.

- **Events referred to:** the **failure of the 1848 liberal revolution** in Germany. The Frankfurt parliament's constitution was rejected by Friedrich Wilhelm IV, King of Prussia; monarchs, the aristocracy and the military opposed the assembly, and troops forced it to disband.
- So the dream of a free, united Germany under an elected parliament had **fallen**.

### 🧪 Activity · Fig. 19 / Fig. 10 – Germania and the Frankfurt parliament

**?** **Look once more at Fig. 10. Imagine you were a citizen of Frankfurt in March 1848 present during the proceedings of the parliament. How would you (a) as a man seated in the hall of deputies, and (b) as a woman observing from the galleries, relate to the banner of Germania hanging from the ceiling?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**(a) As a man (deputy):** I would feel **proud and inspired**. Germania – free, strong and heroic under the black, red and gold flag – stands for the united German nation we are drafting a constitution for. I would feel I am helping to build a new era.

**(b) As a woman in the gallery:** I would feel **mixed emotions**. The nation is shown as a woman, yet women like me were **denied the vote** and could only watch from the visitors' gallery. I would admire the banner but ask why the freedom it stands for is not given to women too.

## ⭐ Write in brief

**1 (a)** **Write a note on: Giuseppe Mazzini**

✔ ANSWER

- Italian revolutionary, born in **Genoa in 1805**; member of the secret society **Carbonari**.
- Sent into exile in **1831**, at 26, for attempting a revolution in Liguria.
- Founded **Young Italy** (Marseilles) and **Young Europe** (Berne), with members from Poland, France, Italy and the German states.
- Believed nations were the natural units of mankind; Italy must be a **single unified republic**.
- His opposition to monarchy frightened conservatives; Metternich called him 'the most dangerous enemy of our social order'.

**1 (b)** **Write a note on: Count Camillo de Cavour**

✔ ANSWER

- **Chief Minister of Sardinia-Piedmont** who led the movement to unify Italy.
- He was **neither a revolutionary nor a democrat**; like many of the Italian elite he spoke French better than Italian.
- Through a tactful **diplomatic alliance with France**, Sardinia-Piedmont defeated the **Austrian forces in 1859**.
- This paved the way for Victor Emmanuel II to be proclaimed king of united Italy in **1861**.

**1 (c)** **Write a note on: The Greek war of independence**

✔ ANSWER

- Greece had been part of the **Ottoman Empire** since the fifteenth century; the struggle for independence began in **1821**.
- Greek nationalists got support from Greeks in exile and from West Europeans who admired ancient Greek culture.
- Poets and artists praised Greece as the **cradle of European civilisation**; **Lord Byron** raised funds and died fighting (1824).
- The **Treaty of Constantinople (1832)** recognised Greece as an independent nation. It mobilised nationalist feelings among the educated elite across Europe.

**1 (d)** **Write a note on: Frankfurt parliament**

✔ ANSWER

- Middle-class political associations in the German regions voted for an **all-German National Assembly**.
- On **18 May 1848**, **831 elected representatives** took their places in the parliament in the **Church of St Paul, Frankfurt**.
- They drafted a constitution for a German nation headed by a **monarchy subject to a parliament**.
- **Friedrich Wilhelm IV, King of Prussia**, rejected the crown and opposed the assembly; the middle-class parliament lost the support of workers and artisans, and troops forced it to **disband**.

**1 (e)** **Write a note on: The role of women in nationalist struggles**

✔ ANSWER

- Large numbers of women took an **active part** in the liberal and nationalist movements.
- They formed their own **political associations**, founded **newspapers** and joined meetings and demonstrations (e.g. **Louise Otto-Peters**).

- Yet they were **denied suffrage** in the election of the Frankfurt Assembly and were admitted only as **observers** in the visitors' gallery.
- Women continued to organise movements demanding **equal political rights**.

**2** **What steps did the French revolutionaries take to create a sense of collective identity among the French people?**

✔ ANSWER

- Ideas of **la patrie** (the fatherland) and **le citoyen** (the citizen) stressed a united community with equal rights under a constitution.
- A new French flag, the **tricolour**, replaced the royal standard.
- The Estates General was elected by active citizens and renamed the **National Assembly**.
- New **hymns** were composed, **oaths** taken and **martyrs** commemorated in the name of the nation.
- A **centralised administrative system** made **uniform laws** for all citizens.
- Internal customs duties were abolished and a **uniform system of weights and measures** adopted.

- Regional dialects were discouraged; **French as spoken in Paris** became the common language.

**3** **Who were Marianne and Germania? What was the importance of the way in which they were portrayed?**

✔ ANSWER

- **Marianne** was the female allegory of the **French nation**; **Germania** was the female allegory of the **German nation**.
- **Marianne:** a popular Christian name, showing a **people's nation**; her symbols – red cap, tricolour, cockade – came from Liberty and the Republic. Statues stood in public squares; her image was on coins and stamps.
- **Germania:** wears a **crown of oak leaves**, since the German oak stands for **heroism**.

**Importance:** they gave the **abstract idea of the nation a concrete form**, reminded people of national unity and **persuaded them to identify with the nation**.

**4** **Briefly trace the process of German unification.**

✔ ANSWER

- Nationalist feelings were strong among **middle-class Germans**, who in **1848** tried to unite the German confederation under an elected parliament (Frankfurt parliament).
- This liberal effort was **repressed** by the monarchy and military, supported by the **Junkers** (large landowners) of Prussia.
- **Prussia** then led the movement; its chief minister **Otto von Bismarck** was its architect, using the Prussian army and bureaucracy.
- **Three wars over seven years** – with **Austria, Denmark and France** – ended in Prussian victory.
- On **18 January 1871**, **William I** of Prussia was proclaimed **German Emperor** in the Hall of Mirrors at **Versailles**.
- The new state modernised currency, banking, legal and judicial systems; Prussian practices became a model for Germany.

**5** **What changes did Napoleon introduce to make the administrative system more efficient in the territories ruled by him?**

✔ ANSWER

- The **Civil Code of 1804 (Napoleonic Code)** abolished privileges based on birth, gave **equality before the law** and secured the **right to property**; it was exported to the conquered regions.

- In the Dutch Republic, Switzerland, Italy and Germany he **simplified administrative divisions**.
- He **abolished the feudal system** and freed peasants from **serfdom and manorial dues**.
- In towns, **guild restrictions** were removed.
- **Transport and communication** systems were improved.
- Uniform laws, standard weights and measures and a common currency helped trade.

## 💬 Discuss

**1** **Explain what is meant by the 1848 revolution of the liberals. What were the political, social and economic ideas supported by the liberals?**

✔ ANSWER

**1848 revolution of the liberals:** alongside the revolts of the poor in 1848, the **educated middle classes** led a revolution. In France it brought the abdication of the monarch and a republic with universal male suffrage. In Germany, Italy, Poland and the Austro-Hungarian Empire, liberals combined demands for **constitutionalism with national unification** – a nation-state with a constitution, freedom of the press and freedom of association (e.g. the **Frankfurt parliament**).

**Political ideas:**

- **Government by consent**; end of autocracy and clerical privileges.
- A **constitution** and **representative government** through parliament.

**Social ideas:**

- **Freedom of the individual** and **equality before the law**; abolition of aristocratic privileges, serfdom and bonded labour.
- But equality did not mean universal suffrage: voting was often limited to **property-owning men**; women were denied political rights.

**Economic ideas:**

- **Freedom of markets**; abolition of state restrictions on movement of goods and capital.
- **Inviolability of private property**; a unified economic territory, e.g. the **zollverein** (1834).

Though suppressed, the liberals forced monarchs to grant concessions after 1848.

**2** **Choose three examples to show the contribution of culture to the growth of nationalism in Europe.**

✔ ANSWER

- **Romanticism and folk culture (Germany):** Herder said true German culture lay among the common people (**das volk**); folk songs, poetry and dances spread the national spirit (volksgeist). The **Grimm Brothers** collected German folktales and made a German dictionary to oppose French domination.
- **Music and language (Poland):** Karol Kurpinski's operas and music turned folk dances (**polonaise, mazurka**) into national symbols; after Russian occupation the clergy used the **Polish language** in church as a weapon of resistance.
- **Art (Greece):** Delacroix's painting **The Massacre at Chios** (1824) and poets like Lord Byron created sympathy for the Greek struggle.
- Also, artists **personified the nation** as female figures – **Marianne** (France) and **Germania** (Germany).

Thus art, poetry, music and language created a sense of a **shared cultural past**, the basis of nationalism.

**3** **Through a focus on any two countries, explain how nations developed over the nineteenth century.**

✔ ANSWER

**Germany:**

- Middle-class liberals tried to unite Germany through the **Frankfurt parliament (1848)**, but it was crushed by the monarchy and military.
- **Prussia** under **Bismarck** took the lead; with the army and bureaucracy it won **three wars** (Austria, Denmark, France).
- In **January 1871**, **William I** was proclaimed German Emperor at Versailles – unification 'from above'.

**Italy:**

- Italy was divided into seven states. **Mazzini** (Young Italy) tried for a united republic, but uprisings of 1831 and 1848 failed.
- **Sardinia-Piedmont** under **Victor Emmanuel II** and Chief Minister **Cavour**, allied with France, defeated Austria in **1859**.
- **Garibaldi** and his Red Shirts took South Italy and the Kingdom of the Two Sicilies in **1860**.
- In **1861** Victor Emmanuel II became king of united Italy; Rome (Papal States) joined in **1870**.

In both countries nations were formed mainly through **war, diplomacy and state power**, not democratic movements.

**4** **How was the history of nationalism in Britain unlike the rest of Europe?**

✔ ANSWER

- In Britain the nation-state was formed **not by a sudden revolution** but by a **long-drawn-out process**.
- Before the 18th century there was no British nation; people had **ethnic identities** – English, Welsh, Scot, Irish.
- The **English parliament**, which seized power from the monarchy in **1688**, became the instrument for forging a nation-state with England at its centre.
- The **Act of Union (1707)** with Scotland formed the 'United Kingdom of Great Britain'; Scotland's culture was suppressed – Highlanders could not speak **Gaelic** or wear national dress.
- **Ireland**, divided between Catholics and Protestants, was forcibly incorporated in **1801** after the failed revolt of Wolfe Tone (1798).
- A 'British nation' was built by spreading **English culture**: Union Jack, national anthem, English language; older nations became subordinate partners.

So British nationalism grew through the **dominance of one ethnic group (English)**, unlike the revolutionary and unification movements elsewhere in Europe.

**5** **Why did nationalist tensions emerge in the Balkans?**

✔ ANSWER

- The **Balkans** was a region of geographical and **ethnic variety** (modern Romania, Bulgaria, Albania, Greece, Macedonia, Croatia, Bosnia-Herzegovina, Slovenia, Serbia, Montenegro); its people were broadly called **Slavs**.
- A large part was under the **Ottoman Empire**, which was **disintegrating**; the spread of **romantic nationalism** made the region explosive.
- Subject nationalities broke away one by one, claiming they had once been independent and were trying to **win back lost independence**.
- The Balkan states were **fiercely jealous** of each other; each wanted more territory at the cost of others.
- **Big power rivalry**: Russia, Germany, England and Austro-Hungary each wanted to extend its control over the Balkans, linked to rivalry over trade, colonies and military might.

This led to a series of wars in the region and finally the **First World War** (1914).

## Project

**Find out more about nationalist symbols in countries outside Europe. For one or two countries, collect examples of pictures, posters or music that are symbols of nationalism. How are these different from European examples?**

SAMPLE ANSWER

**Model project plan – India:**

- **Pictures:** Abanindranath Tagore's painting of **Bharat Mata** (a calm, ascetic woman giving food, cloth, learning).
- **Song: Vande Mataram** by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay.
- **Flag:** the Swaraj flag (1921) with the **spinning wheel** (charkha) at the centre, a symbol of self-help.
- **Posters:** Swadeshi and Quit India posters; photographs of the Dandi March.

**How they differ from European examples:**

- European symbols (Marianne, Germania, Britannia) often showed **power, swords, armour** and even empire; Indian symbols stressed **spirituality, self-reliance, non-violence** and unity of different communities.
- Indian nationalism grew **against colonial rule**, so its symbols expressed anti-imperialism, while many European symbols celebrated the state or empire.

> Present the collection in a scrapbook or chart with captions.

🎉 **Chapter 1 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**